

27 FEBRUARY 2026

THIS IS THE MILITARY SEALIFT COMMAND NORFOLK, STRATEGIC SEALIFT
PROGRAM SUPPORT OFFICE, N103A

SOURCE SOUGHT NOTIFICATION NO. N32205-SS-26-PM4-065

SUBJECT: MCM OPEN-OCEAN TOW MISSION

1. THIS IS MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED BY THE PM4 PROGRAM OFFICE OF MSC. IT IS A REQUEST FOR INFORMATION ONLY, AND YOUR RESPONSE WILL NOT BE CONSIDERED AN OFFER. THIS REQUEST FOR INFORMATION DOES NOT COMMIT THE GOVERNMENT TO PAY ANY COSTS INCURRED IN THE PREPARATION OR SUBMISSION TO THIS MARKET SURVEY OR TO CONTRACT FOR SERVICES.

2. MSC REQUESTS INFORMATION ABOUT THE PRICE AND AVAILABILITY OF ONE (1) U.S. OR FOREIGN FLAG, OCEAN-GOING CERTIFIED TUGBOAT CAPABLE OF ESCORTING AND POTENTIALLY TOWING (MANNED TOW, EMERGENCY SITUATIONS ONLY) UP TO TWO (2) U.S. NAVY AVENGER-CLASS MINE COUNTERMEASURE (MCM) VESSELS. AVENGER-CLASS VESSEL PARTICULARS ARE DESCRIBED BELOW. TUGBOAT MUST BE CAPABLE OF RIGGING AND COMMENCING AN EMERGENCY TOW OF AVENGER-CLASS MCM(S) AT SEA. THE REQUIREMENT IS FOR ONE VOYAGE.

3. DESCRIPTION OF THE TOW:

- DISPLACEMENT – 1,312 LT
- LENGTH – 224'
- BEAM – 39'
- MAX DRAFT – 15'
- GENERAL ARRANGEMENT DRAWINGS AVAILABLE ON REQUEST

4. PORT(S)/PLACE(S) OF DEPARTURE: U.S. FLEET ACTIVITIES SASEBO, JAPAN.

5. LAYTIME: FOUR (4) DAYS FOR THE ENTIRE MISSION.

6. PORT(S)/PLACE(S) OF DESTINATION: NAVAL SUPPORT ACTIVITY BAHRAIN

7. LAYDAYS: COMMENCING/CANCELLING: PROMPT (OFFEROR INDICATE FIRST DATE OF AVAILABILITY)

8. TUG REQUIREMENTS:

- VESSEL/TUG SHALL BE BUILT IN 1970 OR LATER.
- BOLLARD PULL: SUFFICIENT TO TOW MCM VESSEL AT A MINIMUM TOW SPEED OF SIX (6) KNOTS FOR FIVE (5) KNOT SOA IN BEAUFORT 5 CONDITIONS. MAXIMUM TOW SPEED TO BE CALCULATED IAW THE U.S. NAVY TOW MANUAL.
- TUG SHALL BE FULLY BUNKERED FOR THE VOYAGE.

- STOPS FOR FUEL OR SUPPLIES ARE AUTHORIZED.
- INTERNET AND SATELLITE PHONE CAPABILITY.
- CONTRACTOR MUST PROVIDE TOW BRIDLE AND HARDWARE, EMERGENCY TOW LINES, FLOODING ALARMS, NAVIGATION LIGHTS AND DAY SHAPES IAW THE COLREGS RULES OF THE ROAD.
- U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL (SL740-AA-MAN-10) WILL BE USED AND COMPLIED WITH FOR THIS REQUIREMENT. THE LINK FOR DOWNLOAD IS: <HTTP://WWW.NAVSEA.NAVY.MIL/HOME/SUPSALV/00C2-SALVAGE-PUBLICATIONS/>.
- CONTRACTOR MUST PREPARE AND SUBMIT A NOTIONAL TOWING PLAN FOR REVIEW AND APPROVAL PRIOR TO COMMENCEMENT OF TOW.
- INSPECTION AND ACCEPTANCE OF ALL WORK SHALL BE BY THE CHIEF ENGINEER, ON-SITE MANAGEMENT TEAM REPRESENTATIVE.
- TRAIL TUG SHALL BE USED IN RESTRICTED, INLAND AND CHANNEL WATERS, AND IN ANY OTHER CIRCUMSTANCES WHERE CLOSE QUARTERS SITUATIONS EXIST, TO CONTROL THE VESSEL IN TOW IN ACCORDANCE WITH LOCAL REQUIREMENTS.
- LUMP SUM AMOUNT SHALL INCLUDE UP TO FOUR (4) DAYS OF LAYTIME
- POSITION REPORTS. POSITION REPORTS SHALL BE ISSUED BY ELECTRONIC MAIL: VESSEL SHALL PROVIDE POSITION/STATUS REPORT IN PORT TWICE DAILY AT 0000Z AND 1200Z AND AT-SEA FOUR TIMES DAILY AT 0000Z, 0600Z, 1200Z, AND 1800Z. ADDITIONALLY, POSITION/STATUS REPORTS SHALL BE SENT UPON DEPARTURE AND ARRIVAL, AND AT OTHER TIMES REQUESTED BY THE APPLICABLE MSC AREA COMMAND FOR FORCE PROTECTION REASONS. REPORTS SHALL BE SENT TO THE EMAIL ADDRESSES THAT WILL BE PROVIDED AFTER THE CONTRACT AWARD.
- TECHNICAL DOCUMENTS AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST.

9. INTERESTED PARTIES ARE REQUESTED TO PROVIDE THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION:

- A. NAME AND COMPLETE DESCRIPTION/CHARACTERISTICS OF THE TOW VESSEL INCLUDING CERTIFICATE OF INSPECTION (COI), CERTIFICATE OF DOCUMENTATION (COD) OR CLASSIFICATION SOCIETY EQUIVALENT, PHOTOS, AND ALL DELIVERABLES AS PER MSC PROFORMA TUGCON 2024 (REV.1 (12-24)).
- B. DURATION OF PLANNED VOYAGE (IN DAYS, HOURS, AND MINUTES). INTERESTED PARTIES ARE TO PROVIDE A TENTATIVE VOYAGE PLAN USING THE MOST DIRECT ROUTE BETWEEN LOADING AND DISCHARGE PORTS INDICATING DISTANCE (IN NAUTICAL MILES) AND ANTICIPATED SPEED (IN KNOTS). GRAPHICAL DEPICTIONS FROM VOYAGE PLANNING SOFTWARE DISPLAYING A PROPOSED TRACKLINE ARE HIGHLY DESIRED, BUT NOT REQUIRED. ESCORT VESSEL WILL BE REQUIRED TO FOLLOW THE ORDERS OF THE SENIOR COMMANDING OFFICER OF THE TWO MCMs. ESCORT VESSEL WILL LIKELY GO NO FASTER THAN 8 KNOTS FOR THE DURATION OF THE VOYAGE AND MUST REMAIN WITHIN VISUAL RANGE OF THE MCMs (5 TO 10 NAUTICAL MILES).

- C. POTENTIAL LOGISTIC STOPS (FUEL, FOOD, PERSONNEL, ETC.) PLANNED FOR THE VOYAGE. LOGISTIC STOPS MUST BE KEPT TO A MINIMUM SO AS NOT TO IMPACT THE MOVEMENT OF THE MCMs. INDICATE POTENTIAL PORT NAME(S), REASON(S) FOR STOPPING (FUEL, PROVISIONS, ETC), AND POTENTIAL PORT CHARGES (INCLUDING FUEL) EXPECTED AT ANY STOP.
- D. RESPOND WITH THE MAXIMUM NUMBER OF SUPERCARGOES THE ESCORT TUG CAN SUPPORT AS WELL AS THE DAILY COST FOR BERTHING AND MESSING OF EACH SUPER CARGO. POTENTIAL BERTHING ARRANGEMENTS (SINGLE ROOMS/HEADS, SHARED ROOMS/HEADS, ETC.) ARE ALSO OF INTEREST.
- E. RESPOND WITH THE ABILITY OF THE ESCORT TUG TO COMMENCE EMERGENCY TOW OF A SINGLE MCM AT SEA IAW THE REQUIREMENTS OF THE U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL.
- F. LUMP SUM (INCLUDE UP TO 4 DAYS AT DESTINATION SITE FOR CUSTOMS/DELIVERY) AND DEMURRAGE RATE.
- G. BUSINESS SIZE. IF OTHER THAN SMALL BUSINESS, PROVIDE A NARRATIVE OF SUB-CONTRACTING POSSIBILITIES ENVISIONED, IF ANY. IF NONE, PROVIDE AN EXPLANATION.
- H. ANY OTHER PERTINENT QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS INCLUDING 46 CFR, CHAPTER 1, SUBCHAPTER M - TOWING VESSELS.

10. THE FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION 19.102 ESTABLISHES THE SMALL BUSINESS SIZE STANDARD FOR THIS TYPE OF WATER TRANSPORTATION SERVICE AS NAICS "483111" WITH A SMALL BUSINESS SIZE LIMITATION OF 1,050 EMPLOYEES. PLEASE INDICATE IF BUSINESS IS A SMALL BUSINESS CONCERN.

11. RESPONSES ARE REQUESTED, VIA EMAIL, PRIOR TO 1100 HOURS, EASTERN TIME, 03 MARCH 2026. THE POINT OF CONTACT DAVID ANAYA, EMAIL DAVID.C.ANAYA.CIV@US.NAVY.MIL, OR TEL (564) 226-8419.

SIGNED: CHRISTOPHER TOMLIN, CONTRACTING OFFICER, MSC, N103